

Bee or Yellow Jacket Sting - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1014 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- Insect bite/sting and allergic-reaction assessment decomposed from NHS.UK's published when-to-get-help guidance.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the person's exact age and sex, are they pregnant, what insect was involved if safely known, where and how many stings occurred, and is there a prescribed allergy plan or adrenaline device?
2. [YES_NO] Has the caller had a serious allergic reaction to a sting before?
3. [OPEN_TEXT] How many stings, and does the caller carry an adrenaline auto-injector (EpiPen)?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Anaphylaxis

Are throat or tongue swelling, breathing difficulty, faintness, confusion, or collapse present?

Systemic airway, breathing, circulation, or consciousness features require the Anaphylaxis pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Are the lips, mouth, throat or tongue suddenly swollen, is the person breathing very fast or struggling to breathe, is the throat tight or hard to swallow, has the skin or lips turned blue, grey or pale, has the person suddenly become very confused, drowsy, or dizzy, or has anyone lost consciousness or become floppy?

NHS.UK insect bites and stings guidance lists these signs of a serious allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) as Qatar 999 criteria - use an adrenaline auto-injector immediately if one is available.

1. Disposition level 70

Are symptoms worsening or not improving, was the sting in the mouth, throat, or near the eyes, is there abdominal pain and vomiting, dizziness, a high fever with swollen glands, more than one sting, or a previous serious allergic reaction to a sting?

NHS.UK guidance lists these as reasons to seek urgent clinical review or arrange a primary-care review urgently rather than manage entirely at home.

1. Disposition level 50

Is the skin around the sting hot to touch, red, painful, swollen, or leaking pus or fluid, or is this a child under 1 year old, or a tick bite with flu-like symptoms or a bullseye rash?

NHS.UK guidance flags these infection or tick-bite signs as needing a pharmacist or primary-care review.

1. Disposition level 15

Is this a single, minor sting or bite with none of the features above?

NHS.UK guidance describes minor stings/bites without infection or allergy signs as manageable at home.

Advice

Qatar emergency sting/anaphylaxis response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan. Keep them flat unless breathing is easier sitting with legs extended or they are vomiting; use the left side in pregnancy. Do not allow standing or walking. A second prescribed device and timing must follow the approved plan/999 instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: airway swelling or breathing difficulty; faintness, confusion, floppiness, or collapse; symptoms persist or recur.

Urgent sting review

- Remove the stinger if visible by scraping (not squeezing), apply a cold compress, and arrange same-day medical review.
- Call Back If: swelling spreads; breathing becomes difficult.

Routine sting/bite follow-up

- Keep the area clean, apply a cold compress, and book a routine review for signs of infection or a tick bite.
- Call Back If: increasing redness or pain; fever develops.

Governed care for a minor local sting

- Move away from the insect, scrape out a visible bee stinger sideways without squeezing the venom sac, wash the area, elevate if practical, and use a wrapped cool pack briefly. Pain, antihistamine, and topical medicine require age, weight, pregnancy/breastfeeding, allergy, site, sedation risk, and current-medicine checks under the approved Qatar pathway.
- Call Back If: swelling rapidly worsens or involves mouth/neck; breathing, swallowing, dizziness, vomiting, or generalized hives; signs of infection.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 and do not drive. Use the person's prescribed adrenaline auto-injector immediately according to its instructions and emergency plan. Keep them flat unless breathing is easier sitting with legs extended or they are vomiting; use the left side in pregnancy. Do not allow standing or walking. A second prescribed device and timing must follow the approved plan/999 instructions. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Insect bites and stings", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/insect-bites-and-stings/> (page last reviewed 01 June 2023)

Provenance

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